PRISM

On June 6, 2013, the *Guardian* and the *Washington Post* newspapers published separate articles about another NSA data-collection program, PRISM. PRISM collected data on foreign users of Google, Yahoo, Microsoft, Facebook, YouTube, Skype, AOL, Apple, and Paltalk. The leaked document was a top-secret NSA PowerPoint presentation, which showed that more Internet providers, including the company Dropbox, were scheduled to be included in the program after 2012.

Unlike the NSA's Verizon program, in which the NSA requested certain data, PRISM gave intelligence services direct access to the companies' servers. It allowed the collection of not only metadata but content as well, including live chats, file transfers, photos, videos, search history, e-mail content, and social networking details. Because it had direct access to servers, the NSA did not have to get individual court orders. According to the PowerPoint presentation, this was the reason PRISM was introduced—to get around FISA court restrictions. The presentation claimed, "FISA was broken because it provided privacy protections to people who were not entitled to them."[5]

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